

INCIDENT REPORT 3

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Report ID: IR-003
Incident Name: New Local User Creation — Windows
Date/Time: May 4, 2026, use exact timestamp from Wazuh alert
Severity: MEDIUM
Status: Resolved (lab environment)
Environment: Wazuh 4.7.5 Mini SOC Home Lab
Analyst: Jazz

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

At approximately May 4, 2026, Wazuh SIEM detected the creation of a new local user account on the Windows endpoint DESKTOP-HTP16PA. The activity was generated intentionally in the lab to test Windows account monitoring and persistence-related detections.

New local user creation is important in SOC monitoring because attackers often create additional accounts after gaining access to maintain persistence. If the new account is later added to an administrator group, the risk becomes even higher.

This incident maps to MITRE ATT&CK T1136.001 — Create Account: Local Account under the Persistence tactic.

2. TIMELINE

May 4, 2026 before test

The Windows endpoint DESKTOP-HTP16PA was active and connected to Wazuh.

May 4, 2026 at test time

A new local user account was created on the Windows endpoint.

May 4, 2026 shortly after user creation

Windows Security Event Log recorded the user creation event.

May 4, 2026 shortly after event generation

Wazuh collected the Windows account event.

May 4, 2026 after alert review

The analyst reviewed the Wazuh Security Events dashboard.

May 4, 2026 after investigation
The event was confirmed as a true positive lab simulation.

3. DETECTION SOURCE

Tool: Wazuh SIEM/XDR
Wazuh Version: 4.7.5
Detection Area: Windows account management monitoring
Log Source: Windows Security Event Log
Windows Event ID: 4720 — A user account was created
Affected Agent: DESKTOP-HTP16PA
Agent OS: Windows 10 Home
Agent IP: 192.168.56.101

Observed Wazuh Rule:

- Windows new user account created / account management alert
- Use the exact Wazuh rule ID shown in your alert screenshot

Severity:

- Medium, unless the account was added to Administrators
- High if followed by administrator group membership

4. MITRE ATT&CK MAPPING

Tactic: Persistence
Technique: Create Account
Sub-technique: T1136.001 — Local Account

Explanation:

The activity maps to Persistence because attackers may create local accounts to maintain access even if their original access method is removed. A new local account can allow future logins and can be abused for continued access.

Potential attacker next steps if successful:

- Add the new user to the Administrators group
- Use the account for future logins
- Hide the account from normal users
- Use the account for lateral movement
- Disable security tools or logs

5. INVESTIGATION FINDINGS

Source:

Local Windows account management activity.

Target:

DESKTOP-HTP16PA Windows endpoint.

Account created:

Use the account name shown in your Windows/Wazuh alert, for example testuser or labuser.

Observed behavior:

- A new local user account was created.
- Windows Security Event Log recorded Event ID 4720.
- Wazuh collected and displayed the account creation event.
- The behavior matched persistence activity.
- The event was mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1136.001.

Evidence reviewed:

- Wazuh Security Events showing account creation activity
- Windows Security Event ID 4720
- Agent name DESKTOP-HTP16PA
- MITRE ATT&CK mapping for Create Account: Local Account

Administrator rights confirmed:

Check whether the user was later added to Administrators. If not, write: No administrator group addition confirmed.

Compromise confirmed:

No. The activity was intentionally generated in a controlled lab.

6. RISK ASSESSMENT

Risk: MEDIUM

Reason:

New local user creation is suspicious when unexpected. Attackers often create new accounts to maintain persistence. The risk becomes high if the account has administrator privileges or appears after another suspicious event such as PowerShell execution or failed login attempts.

The risk is especially high if:

- The user was created by an unusual account

- The account name looks hidden or random
- The account is added to the Administrators group
- The event follows suspicious PowerShell execution
- The account logs in shortly after creation

In this lab, the risk was controlled because the activity was intentional.

7. VERDICT

Verdict: TRUE POSITIVE — Lab Simulation

The alert is a true positive because a local user account was created and the event was detected by Wazuh/Windows logs. It was not a false positive because the account creation activity actually occurred.

In a real SOC, the event would require confirmation from IT or the system owner to determine whether it was authorized.

8. RESPONSE ACTIONS TAKEN

1. Reviewed Wazuh Security Events.
2. Identified the Windows account creation event.
3. Verified the affected agent as DESKTOP-HTP16PA.
4. Confirmed the log source as Windows Security Event Log.
5. Confirmed the event type as new local user creation.
6. Checked whether the account was added to an administrator group.
7. Mapped the behavior to MITRE ATT&CK T1136.001.
8. Documented the incident as a lab-generated true positive.

9. RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Review all new local account creation events.
2. Verify whether the account was authorized.
3. Check who created the account.
4. Check whether the account was added to Administrators.
5. Disable or remove unauthorized local accounts.

6. Monitor for logins from the newly created account.
7. Alert on new local user creation outside maintenance windows.
8. Use least privilege for local accounts.
9. Centralize Windows account management monitoring.
10. Correlate new user creation with PowerShell, failed login, or privilege escalation alerts.

10. FINAL ANALYST NOTE

This incident demonstrates Wazuh's ability to monitor Windows account management activity. New local user creation is an important persistence detection because attackers may create accounts to maintain access. The Mini SOC lab successfully documents this activity using a structured SOC incident report format.